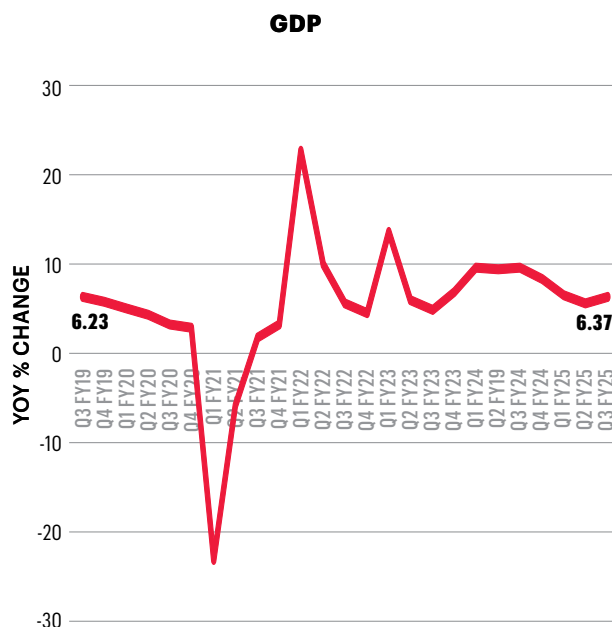
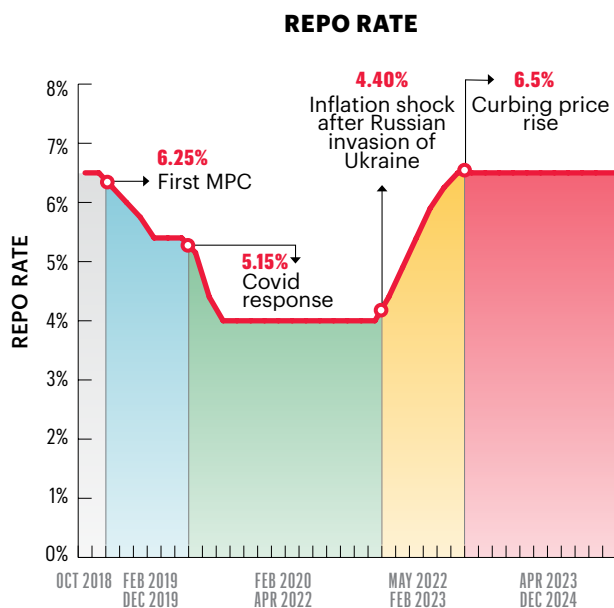


THE DAS YEARS

● Shaktikanta Das' tenure as RBI Governor began with a cut in the repo rate



SOURCE RBI

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short notice. “The key is to begin functioning without overthinking,” he says. Das compares the experience to a batsman: think too much about the next delivery, and the ball would have passed by you and hit the stumps.

Over his six-year tenure, the relationship with the government remained smooth. What did the 25th RBI Governor do differently? Das admits that differences of opinion between the finance ministry and the central bank are natural, given their distinct responsibilities and priorities. “Such differences, however, are best resolved through direct and internal discussions rather than through the media,” Das tells *BT*

at the PMO’s South Block office. Das became Principal Secretary to the Prime Minister after his RBI tenure.

THE NBFC CRISIS

Just months before Das took charge, IL&FS—one of India’s largest NBFC groups—began defaulting on its obligations, triggering a broader liquidity shock. In 2019, the RBI superseded the board of another NBFC, Dewan Housing Finance Corporation.

His first task was restoring normalcy, infusing liquidity and, above all, building back confidence. In one press conference, Das went so far as to say it would be the RBI’s endeavour to ensure that no NBFC

of reasonable size failed. Afterwards, his Deputy Governors told him he had made a very big promise and “stuck his head out.” He replied, “Yes, I have stuck my head out, but you have to make sure my head is protected,” grins Das.

“By emphasising stronger governance, risk management, and capital discipline, Das had made NBFCs more stable while still ensuring that credit reaches underserved economic segments. His leadership balanced caution and practicality, greatly enhancing the long-term stability and reputation of India’s NBFC sector,” says Mehul Pandya, Managing Director & Group CEO at CareEdge.

That was visible in the years